

MEDIEVAL HISTORY



MODULE - 1

TRIPARTITE STRUGGLE



1

Why should we study medieval history for UPSC Civil Service Examination?

A

NUMBER OF QUESTIONS IN PRELIMS

2017	1
2018	2
2019	6

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

DELHI SULTANATE

MUGHALS

TANSEN

B

Some questions in mains requires understanding of Medieval History

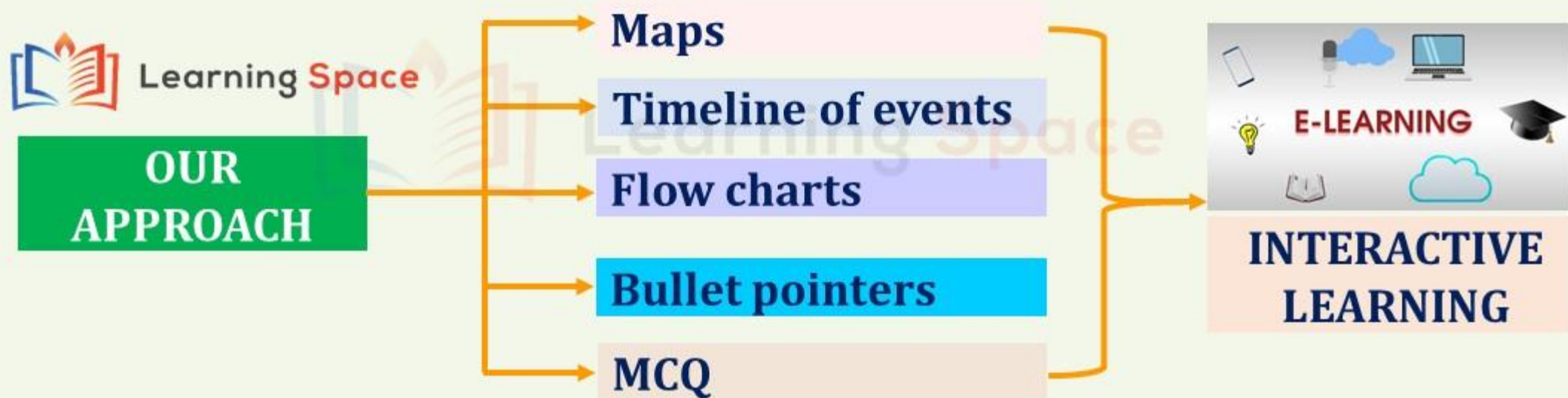
Eg.: Questions on “Battle of Panipat”.
Question of “Vijayanagara Empire”.

C

Dynamic nature of the Prelims

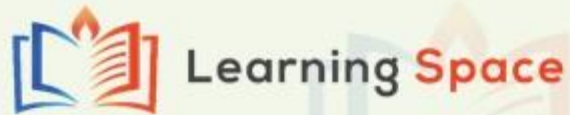
2

How to approach the preparation of Medieval History?



3

From which period should we begin study of Medieval History?



OUR APPROACH



**PERIOD
FROM**

800 AD

TO

1200 AD

4

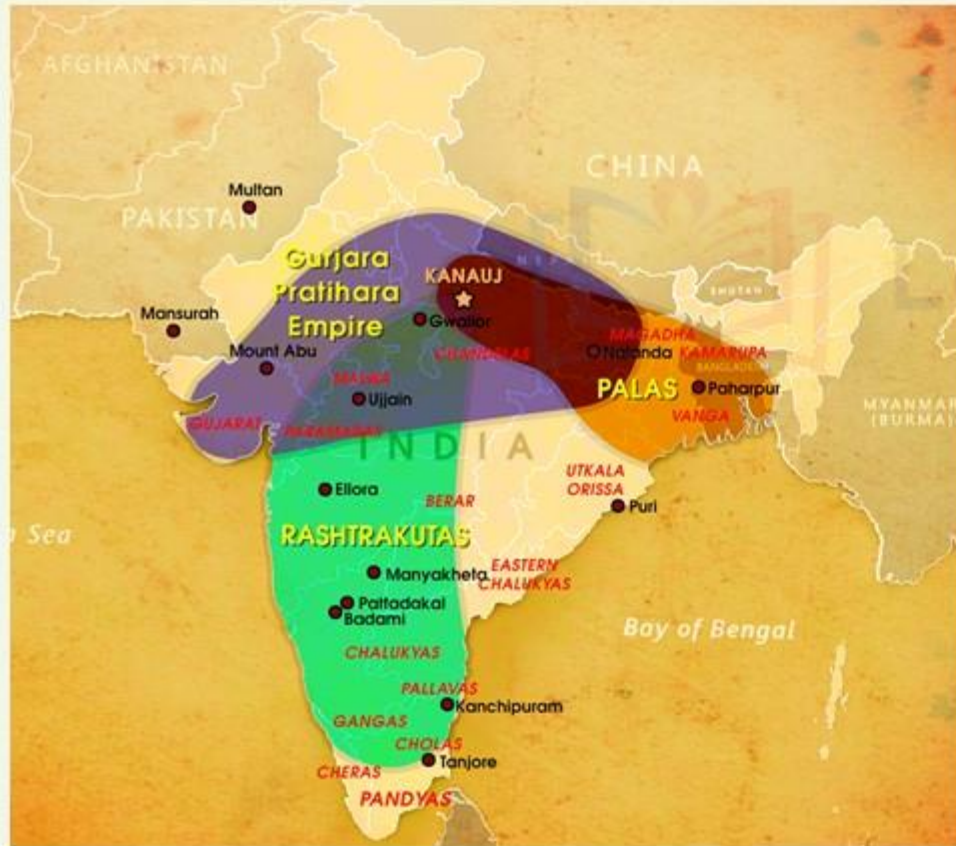
How will we cover Medieval History?



TRIPARTITE STRUGGLE

The Tripartite struggle was a struggle for power and control over the **central Gangetic valley**, for the city of Kannauj, among 3 major empires in India during the 8th Century.

These three empires were:



TRIPARTITE STRUGGLE

THE PRATI HARAS

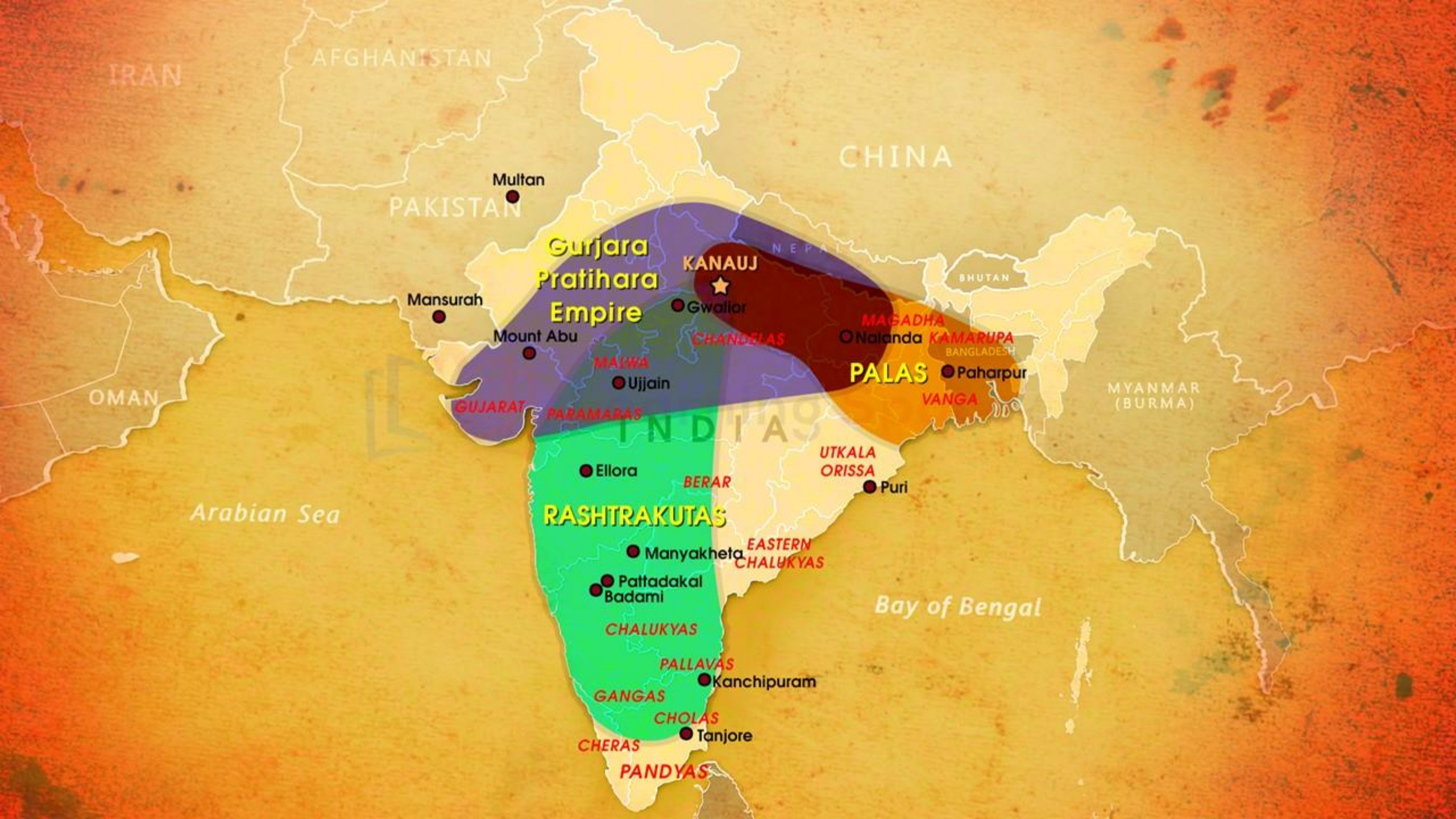
The Pratiharas were settled in western India in the **Avanti - Jalaor** region.

THE RASHTRAKUTAS

The Rastrakutas who were essentially from the Deccan region

THE PALAS

The Palas occupied the eastern parts of India (present day Bengal) and were very strong contenders in this struggle.



IRAN

AFGHANISTAN

CHINA

PAKISTAN

Multan

Gurjara
Pratihara
Empire

KANAUJ

Gwalior

NEPAL

BHUTAN

MAGADHA

Nalanda

KAMARUPA
BANGLADESH

PALAS

Paharpur

VANGA

MYANMAR
(BURMA)

OMAN

Mansurah

Mount Abu

MAIWA

Ujjain

GUJARAT

PARAMARAS

Ellora

BERAR

UTKALA
ORISSA

Puri

Arabian Sea

RASHTRAKUTAS

Manyakheta

Pattadakal
Badami

EASTERN
CHALUKYAS

CHALUKYAS

PALLAVAS

Kanchipuram

GANGAS

CHOLAS

Tanjore

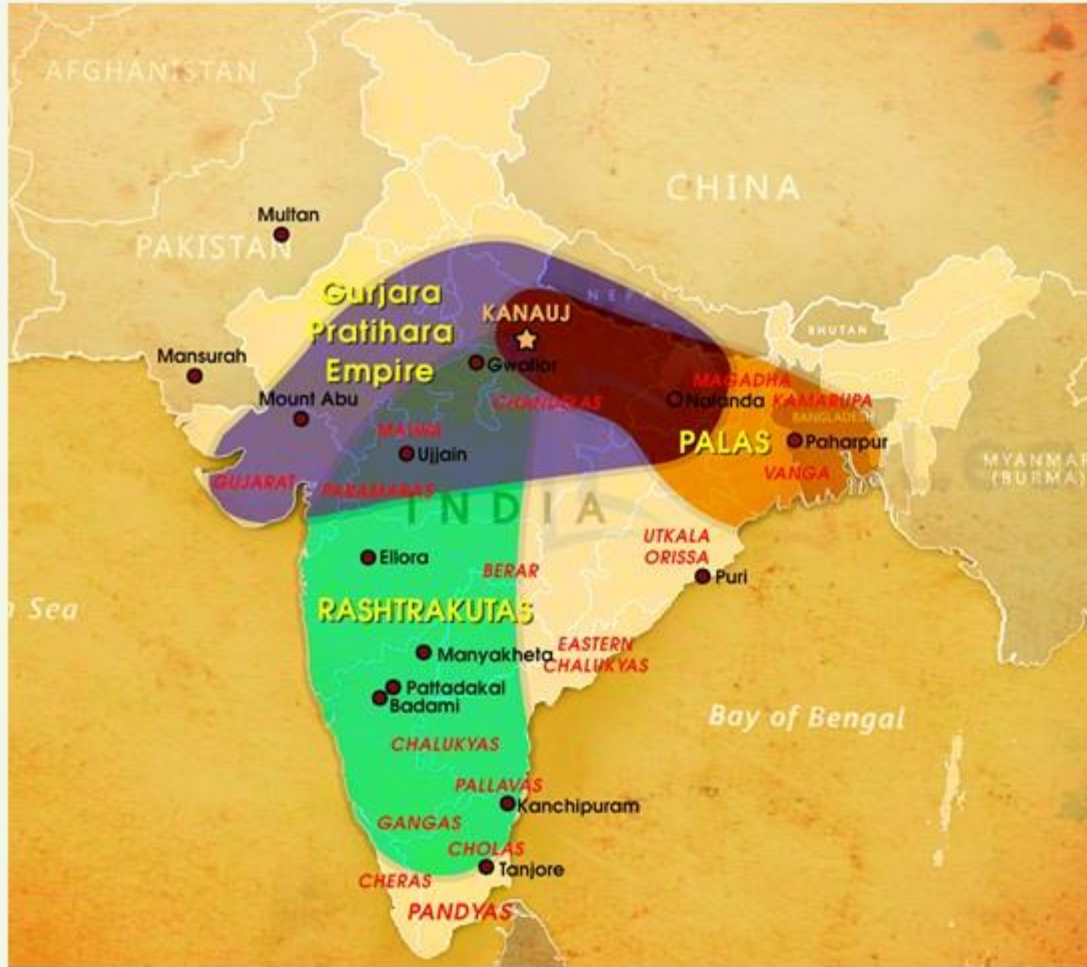
CHERAS

PANDYAS

Bay of Bengal

TRIPARTITE STRUGGLE

WHY KANNAUJ WAS SO IMPORTANT ?



- It was the erstwhile **capital of Harshavardhana** empire in North India. So it was hub for international economic activities and trade.
- It was connected to very important “**Silk Route**”.
- It was a strategic city in fertile land, **drained by Ganga**.
One who captures Kannauj get **control over the rich resources** of the Gangetic valley

- Kannauj commanded high prestige and was “**symbolic of might**” of an empire. It could act as an influencing catalyst to get patronage of smaller kingdoms of India.
- Lust for war booty** which was the important source for maintaining a huge army

Note: *TRIPARTITE STRUGGLE* was also to get control over **Gujarat and Malwa** whose proximity to the coast was very important for foreign trade.



THE SILK ROAD

TASHKENT

KABUL

YUMAN

SHANGHAI

KANNAUJ

DELHI

PATNA

CHINA

INDIA

Caspian Sea

Persian Gulf

Gulf of Oman

Arabian Sea

Bay of Bengal

Gulf of Thailand

South China Sea

Philippine Sea

Sea of Japan

North Pacific Ocean

Okhotsk

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